

Istanbul Bariatric Center NEWSLETTER

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Tips for Ultimate Success



Commit to Lifelong Care at Your Bariatric Clinic:

Dedicate yourself to ongoing care at a bariatric clinic. The specialists there possess the expertise to monitor your health and ensure you maintain a healthy lifestyle, minimizing long-term complications. Primary care physicians might overlook vital aspects of your post-surgery care that bariatric experts won't.

Prioritize Walking as Your Main Exercise:

While it's tempting to reduce exercise as the pounds shed rapidly in the initial post-surgery months, don't underestimate the power of walking. It's the most common and effective long-term exercise for post-op patients. So, put on your sneakers and take a stroll.

Never Compromise on Protein Intake:

Years after your surgery, you might be tempted to return to old eating habits, like cereal and sandwiches. But beware, insufficient protein intake can lead to weight regain. Make protein a cornerstone of half of your meals, complemented by a balanced diet to maintain your interest in healthy eating.

Embrace Fluid Loading:

Staying well-hydrated with water between meals is a strategic approach to combat mindless snacking and overeating. Get yourself a favorite water bottle and aim to consume 100 ounces or more daily in the long term. After six months post-op, consider fluid-loading to reduce your mealtime food intake.



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Strategic Water Consumption:

Continue to avoid fluids during and immediately after your meals. Instead, try drinking a glass of water within the first 10 minutes of starting a meal.

This can contribute to a greater feeling of fullness and potentially reduce your overall food intake. Keep in mind that this 10-minute rule, as opposed to the 30-minute guideline, is recommended for those who are at least six months post-op.

Join a Bariatric Surgery Support Group:

Realize that your journey doesn't conclude when you reach your target weight. Consider joining a bariatric surgery support group to connect with people who share similar experiences. This network can provide invaluable lifelong support. Whether you need a listening ear or can be an inspiration to others, a support group can be a vital resource. If you are a Facebook user, after your booking you'll be added to the private Istanbul Bariatric Center Bariatric Support Group.



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The ultimate long-term goal after bariatric surgery is to lead a normal life, enjoying most foods in moderation. However, it's entirely understandable that many patients have concerns about experiencing adverse effects like dumping syndrome, abdominal discomfort, or vomiting. During the initial three months post-surgery, it's essential to completely avoid certain foods to prevent these issues. Yet, over time, as your body adapts to its new stomach size, many foods can gradually be reintroduced into your diet without causing problems.

Foods to Avoid:

Here are some foods to be cautious about or avoid altogether after bariatric surgery to support your long-term success:

- **High-Sugar Foods:** Sugary items like candies, pastries, and sugary beverages can lead to rapid weight gain and cause dumping syndrome.
- **High-Fat Foods:** Fried foods, creamy sauces, and fatty cuts of meat can be hard to digest and may lead to discomfort.
- **Carbonated Beverages:** They can cause gas and discomfort in your reduced stomach size.
- **Alcohol:** It can be more potent after surgery and should be consumed in moderation.
- **Tough or Fibrous Meats:** These can be difficult to digest, so opt for lean, tender meats.
- **Processed Foods:** Highly processed foods often contain empty calories and limited nutrients. Focus on whole, nutritious foods instead.
- **Large Meals:** Overeating, even of healthy foods, can cause discomfort and weight regain. Stick to smaller, balanced portions.



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Here are some basic reminders to help you maintain a healthy lifestyle after bariatric surgery:

- **Eat slowly** and aim to take 30 minutes to eat a meal. This will help you avoid overeating and ensure that you feel full.
- **Avoid drinking with meals** or for 30 minutes before or after a meal. Drinking too much liquid with your meals can cause discomfort and prevent you from feeling full.

- **Take your essential vitamin and mineral supplements** as prescribed by your doctor. This will help ensure that you get the nutrients your body needs to stay healthy.
- **Avoid grazing or mindless snacking.** Instead, focus on eating balanced meals with small portions. Always eat protein-rich foods first, followed by vegetables and then fruit. Avoid rice, bread, raw vegetables, and fresh fruits, as well as meats that are not easily chewed, such as pork and steak.
- **Be active every day.** Exercise regularly to help you lose as much weight as possible after the operation. You may be given an exercise plan that involves increasing your activity levels gradually as you recover from surgery. Once you've fully recovered, aim to do regular activities that are intense enough to leave you feeling out of breath and make your heart beat faster, such as brisk walking, cycling, gardening or housework.

